

Prototype risk register

List what could go wrong while it is still cheap to find out, and name the cheapest test for each.

How to use it

- ☐ List every risk you can think of in the first week, including the unglamorous ones: thermal, EMC, sourcing, assembly, certification.
- ☐ For each risk, name the **cheapest honest test** that would reveal it, not the test most likely to flatter you.
- ☐ Give every risk one owner and a "test by" date earlier than the next spend commitment (tooling, PO, build).
- ☐ Review the register at every prototype round. Retire a risk only when a test result says so.
- ☐ Anything still open at hand-off goes into the next phase as a written, owned, dated open issue, never as "probably fine".

Register

[illegible]

Check before hand-off

- ☐ Every risk has an owner and a date.
- ☐ Every "retired" risk has a test result behind it.
- ☐ Every open risk is written down with the cost of leaving it open.
- ☐ Nothing is listed as "probably fine".

Why: in the book, hidden risks are the ones that get found at DVT or by customers, at a much higher price. A risk written down can be planned for. A risk nobody wrote down is a surprise.

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